



Switch in time

Belkin launches its range of KVM switches in India

On top of this the port is rather recessed – another ergonomic slip up.

Intex had two monitors in this category: the IT-2003W was pretty ordinary looking with decent build quality but somewhat of a quirky stand that doesn't keep the display 100 per cent stable. Their 2202TVP sports a large, heavy, metal stand and this model comes bundled with a wireless remote control unit. At first we thought it might have television capabilities but there was no connect for a TV cable, although composite and HDMI connects have been provided. The bezel was quite wide on the sides owing to the inbuilt speaker grilles; this makes this monitor look larger than one would expect.

Samsung sent in two displays. The SyncMaster P2250 is an attractive looking monitor with touch controls that are backlit and beautifully made, with good attention to detail – each icon is well backlit and very readable both under fluorescent lighting and in darkness. The on-screen menu is also not in the centre of the monitor but to the right – a fact that we highly appreciated since when testing we need access to the menu systems and our Spyder calibration unit sits on the middle of the screen causing visibility problems – if only more manufacturers gave this option! The 2233RZ was the other Samsung monitor; this one looked really neat with its smart glossy black body and matte screen. The speciality here is this displays' refresh rate, at 120 hertz it is double that of normal displays. This monitor is intended to be used with 3D glasses and other such gear to enable a realistic 3D gaming experience, and although

it's rather unfair to compare it to other displays in this comparison, we are going to do precisely that.

AOC had the strongest presence in this category with four models, some of which were rather special. The V22 was radically different from anything we've seen. Firstly it has a dark blue colour and a wide bezel. The appearance is attractive but in a garish sort of way. Secondly, it was by far the lightest monitor we've ever had the distinction of hefting, far lighter



AOC 2230 Fm

than even a 17-inch display. We discovered this was due to the fact that unlike most LCDs that are CCFL backlit, this one had a white LED (WLED) backlight, meaning the display was slimmer and hopefully a better performer. The AOC F22 embodies a novel concept with a bottom bezel that can also be used as a handle to carry the display, albeit upside down. The stand is similar to a photo frame stand and is detachable. The front is piano black while the rear is glossy white and this contrast really sets the display off. The shape of the stand is weird, something even Priapos would be proud of. The AOC 2230Fm has a neat menu system, the

on-screen display is clear and well laid out and the controls are via a simple four-way joystick with a huge backlit centre button. The buttons work well and although it looks fancy, navigation is really simple. The display bezel is quite narrow, except for the top portion that widens out. A chrome trim on the lower part of the bezel adds a little flavour to what is a plain-looking display by AOCs

standards, judging from others we've seen so far. And the best part – this monitor has additional USB ports and a memory card reader integrated into the back, and along with a wireless remote unit one can enjoy movies, music and photos without a PC, a unique feature and one that is sure to find many eager takers.

The last of the AOC foursome was the 2236Vw, a well built monitor with a really shaky stand, the first gripe we had with this brand. The front bezel is piano black and the rim of the bezel is wide. Due to this, some reflections of the on-screen image can be seen on the rim of the bezel and while not too distracting, it is noticeable. The last display we looked at was the NEC 2190UXp and this display is based on a high-end S-PVA panel. It sports the same industry grade build as the other NEC designs and has an identical stand mechanism. The bezel is the same size as the 24- and 26-inch panels but looks wider owing to the smaller size of the display. This panel had a 4:3 aspect ratio with a resolution of 1600 x 1200 pixels.

Performance

Dell's E228WFP that

LCD Monitor test



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